Internship Proposal: Rethinking High-Functioning Autism in Educational Spaces

Proposal: Working with a school, education nonprofit, or disability advocacy group to study how classrooms shape the experience of high functioning autism

The Problem

Schools Reward:

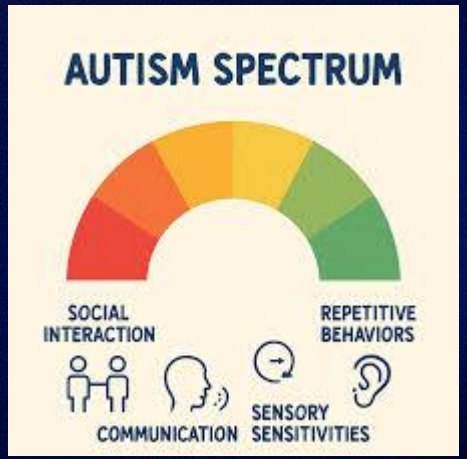
- **Speed of Response**
- **“Normal” Behavior**
- **Eye Contact**
- **Group Discussion**
- **Verbal Participation**

Issue with this:

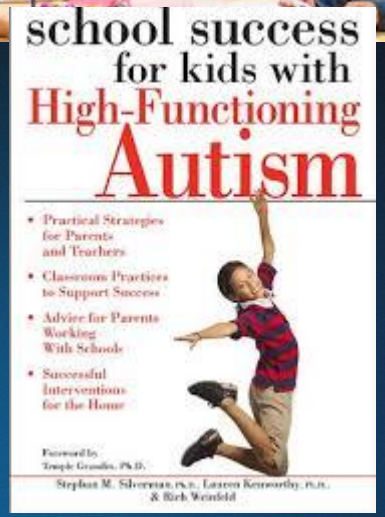
Not key traits of autistic individuals– better at pattern recognition and “silent” traits, not collaboration.

Why Autism Gets Misread

Often framed as deficit; deficit does not mean inability



Internship work



Observe Classrooms

Interview Students/Teachers

Study Participation Norms

Design Better Discussion Structures

Change the Room. Not the Student.

Why it Matters